# Code.org: Which Course Is Right for My Child?

A simple parent guide to Code.org courses, by age and grade.

Code.org | Beginner | Ages 6–14

## The Big Idea

- Code.org is a free, non-profit site with courses that start with simple puzzles and grow up to real programming.
- Courses are organised by school grade. Age is roughly grade + 5.
- Most beginners start with a short Hour of Code activity to see if they enjoy it.
- Then they move into a full course that matches their age.

## CS Fundamentals (Primary School)

- Course A: Kindergarten to grade 1 (about ages 5 to 7). Built for children who are still learning to read.
- Course B: grades 1 to 2 (about ages 6 to 8). Loops, events, then algorithms and conditionals.
- Course C: grades 2 to 3 (about ages 7 to 9).
- Course D: grades 3 to 4 (about ages 8 to 10).
- Course E: grades 4 to 5 (about ages 9 to 11). Includes the Sprite Lab, where kids make a game or drawing.
- Course F: grade 5 (about ages 10 to 11).

## Older Students

- Express Course: grades 3 to 8. A faster path for students who did not do Courses A to F.
- CS Discoveries: grades 6 to 12. Explores things like web design, games and animation, data and physical computing.
- CS Principles: grades 9 to 12. Covers the Internet, data and privacy, and programming and algorithms.
- AP Computer Science A teaches Java and follows an introductory course. Check Code.org for the current details.

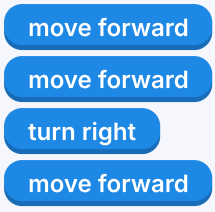
## Accounts and Cost

- Hour of Code and CS Fundamentals Courses A to F can be used without a Code.org account.
- Signing in saves progress and lets a teacher or parent see how a student is doing.
- CS Discoveries and CS Principles need a student account.

- Code.org courses are free. Course names and grade bands can change, so check the Code.org catalogue for the latest.

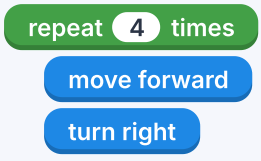
## 💻 What Each Stage Looks Like

**Early stage (Course A or B): sequence** — Code.org blocks




▶ What happens:
The character follows the steps in order, one block at a time, to reach the goal.

**Middle stage (Course C or D): loops** — Code.org blocks




▶ What happens:
Four moves and four turns draw a square. One loop replaces eight blocks.

**Upper primary (Course E): Sprite Lab events** — Code.org blocks




▶ What happens:
The sprite moves when the key is pressed, and the score goes up when it reaches the goal.

## 📚 Key Terms

**Hour of Code**
A one hour starter activity for any age.

**CS Fundamentals**
Code.org courses for grades K to 5.

**Express Course**
A faster course for older beginners.

**Block coding**
Coding by snapping blocks together.

**CS Discoveries**
A middle and high school course.

**Unplugged**
Coding activities with no computer.

**CS Principles**
A high school course about big ideas in computing.

**Grade band**
The school grades a course was written for.

**Sprite Lab**
A Code.org tool for making games and drawings.

**Account**
A free login that saves progress.

## 🧮 Which Course Should We Start With?

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Age 5 to 7   -> Course A or B
Age 7 to 9   -> Course C or D
Age 9 to 11  -> Course E or F
Age 8 to 13 and new to coding -> Express Course
Age 11 to 14 -> CS Discoveries
Age 14 to 17 -> CS Principles
```

## ✏️ Worked Examples

**Q:** My child is 8 and has never coded. Where should we start?

**A:** Try an Hour of Code first. If they enjoy it, Course C or D matches their grade, or the Express Course works as a quicker path.

**Q:** My child is 12 and wants to make apps and games.

**A:** CS Discoveries is written for this age. Express Course is a good warm up if they have no experience.

**Q:** My child is 15 and wants a school-level computing course.

**A:** CS Principles is designed for grades 9 to 12. Java and AP Computer Science A can come later.

## 🚫 Common Mistakes

- Starting a course that is too advanced and then giving up.
- Thinking one Hour of Code is a full course. It is a taster.
- Forgetting to sign in, so progress is not saved.

- Skipping the unplugged lessons, which build real thinking skills.
- Expecting CS Discoveries or CS Principles to work without an account.

## 👨‍👩‍👧 Parent Corner

- Sit with your child for the first session, then step back.
- Ask them to explain a puzzle to you. Teaching is the best test of learning.
- Keep sessions short, around 20 to 30 minutes, and finish on a success.
- Praise persistence when a puzzle is hard.
- If your child needs a guide, InfiBee Coders runs live 1:1 Code.org classes.

## 🎯 Quick Check

**1. Which course is built for children who are still learning to read?**
✅ Course A (and Course B), for the youngest students.

**2. Which Code.org courses can be used without an account?**
✅ Hour of Code and CS Fundamentals Courses A to F.

**3. Which course is written for grades 9 to 12?**
✅ CS Principles.

**4. Roughly what age is a grade 5 student?**
✅ About 10 to 11 years old.

**5. What is a good first step for a new coder?**
✅ Try an Hour of Code activity.